Name the tool you want it to use

A text version of the video, for anyone who cannot watch it.

About this document

The video is 1 minute 21 seconds long. It is narrated by Steven Williams, and captions are available. There is no music and there are no sound effects.

This document follows the video in order, with approximate timings. In each section, “Narration” gives the words as they appear in the captions, “On screen” gives the key words and labels that appear, and “What you see” describes the pictures and movement.

The video is built from the tip’s square card: pale blue paper with faint fibres, ruled like an index card, with a typewriter-style header, a large serif headline and a white panel holding a simple diagram in navy and blue. After the title, the camera zooms into the white panel, and all the explaining happens there, with a narrow border of the card’s paper visible around it. A blue speech bubble with three white dots stands for the chatbot throughout, and blue is used only for the chatbot and the tools it is told to use. A short label in typewriter type in the top-left corner names each part of the video; these labels are used as the section headings below.

If you find any problems with this document or the video, please contact Steven Williams at s.williams10@lse.ac.uk.

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1. The card

0:00 to 0:03

Narration

Name the tool you want it to use.

On screen

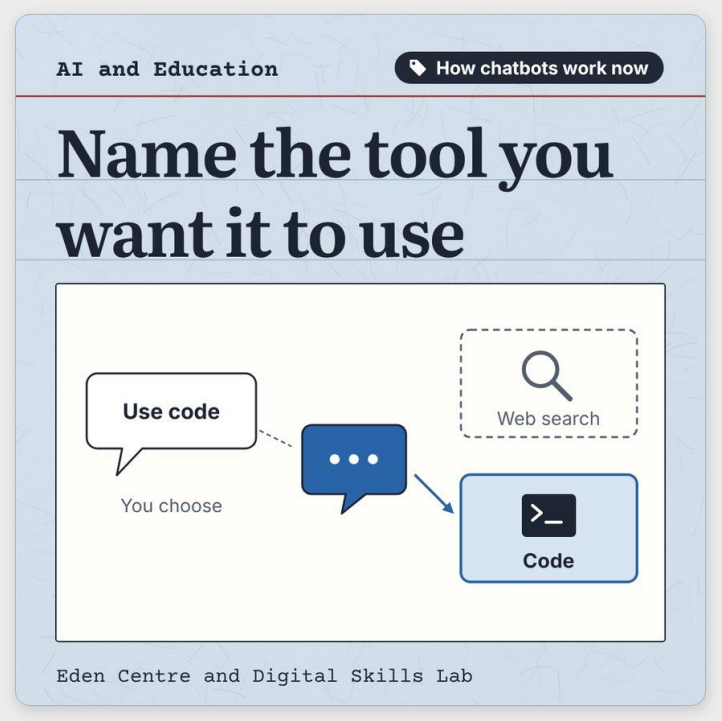
- AI and Education
- How chatbots work now
- Name the tool you want it to use
- Use code
- You choose
- Web search
- Code
- Eden Centre and Digital Skills Lab

What you see

The video opens on the tip card. At the top, “AI and Education” is in typewriter type, beside a dark, rounded tag with a tag icon reading “How chatbots work now”. A red rule runs beneath them, and below it is the headline “Name the tool you want it to use” in a large serif.

Beneath the headline, a white panel holds a diagram. On the left, a white speech bubble reads “Use code”, labelled “You choose”. A dashed line joins it to the blue chatbot bubble in the middle. A blue arrow runs from the chatbot to a pale blue box on the right, with a terminal icon and the label “Code”. Above that box is a dashed, grey box with a magnifying glass, labelled “Web search”, which the chatbot is not using. The footer reads “Eden Centre and Digital Skills Lab”.

After the title, the narration pauses for about two seconds while the camera zooms slowly into the white panel, until it fills most of the screen.



The tip card, as the video opens.

2. Chatbots have tools

0:03 to 0:11

Narration

Chatbots now have tools. But they still work by prediction, so they only use a tool when they predict it's needed.

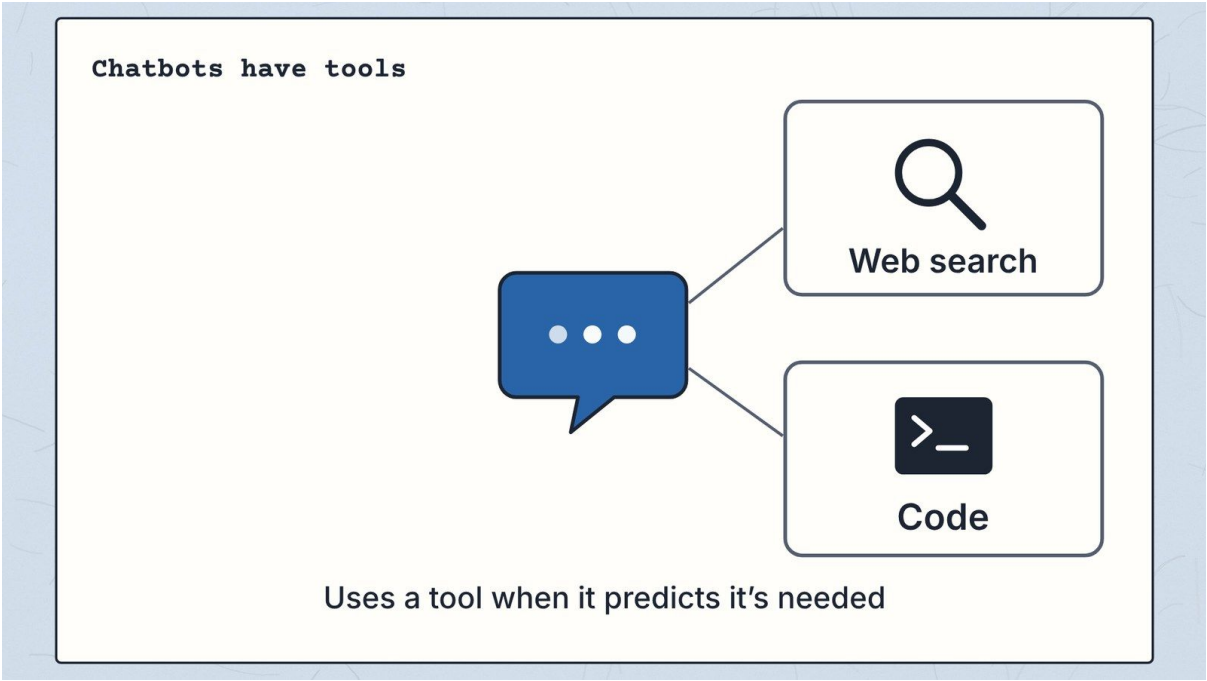
On screen

- Chatbots have tools
- Web search
- Code
- Uses a tool when it predicts it's needed

What you see

The diagram clears, leaving only the blue chatbot bubble, and "Chatbots have tools" appears in the top-left corner. As the narration says "tools", two boxes appear on the right, each joined to the chatbot by a thin grey line: "Web search", with a magnifying glass, then "Code", with a terminal icon.

As the narration mentions prediction, the chatbot's three dots begin to pulse slowly, one after another. When it says "predict", the line "Uses a tool when it predicts it's needed" appears beneath the diagram. The dots stop pulsing at the end of the sentence.



The chatbot and its tools.

3. Without naming the tool: web search

0:11 to 0:20

Narration

If a topic doesn't look time-sensitive, a chatbot may answer from its training data instead of searching the web and give you out-of-date information.

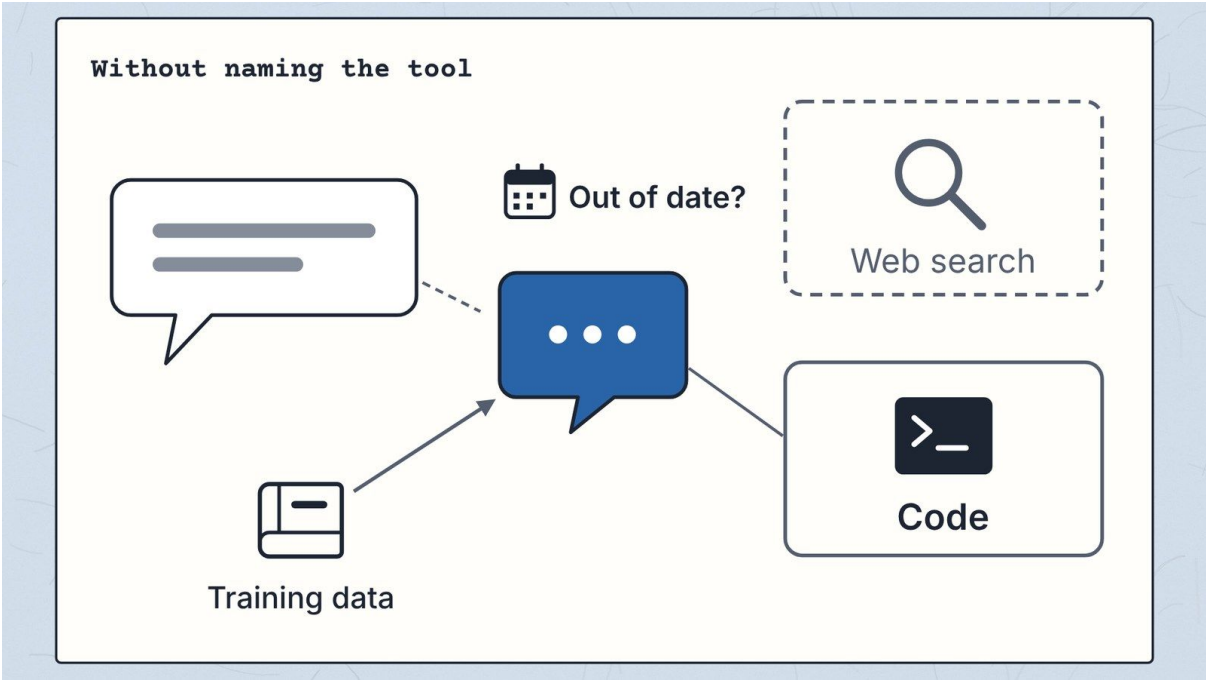
On screen

- Without naming the tool
- Training data
- Out of date?
- Web search
- Code

What you see

The line beneath the diagram fades, and the label in the corner changes to "Without naming the tool". A white speech bubble appears on the left, holding two grey lines in place of words. This is your question, and a dashed line joins it to the chatbot.

As the narration says "training data", a closed book labelled "Training data" appears at the bottom left, with a grey arrow pointing into the chatbot. As it says "instead of searching the web", the Web search box turns dashed and grey, and its line to the chatbot disappears, showing that it is not being used. As it says "out of date", a small calendar icon appears above the chatbot, with the words "Out of date?".



The chatbot answers from its training data.

4. Without naming the tool: code

0:20 to 0:29

Narration

And it may convert a file or do maths with its language model rather than with code, and make mistakes or change details in ways that are hard to notice.

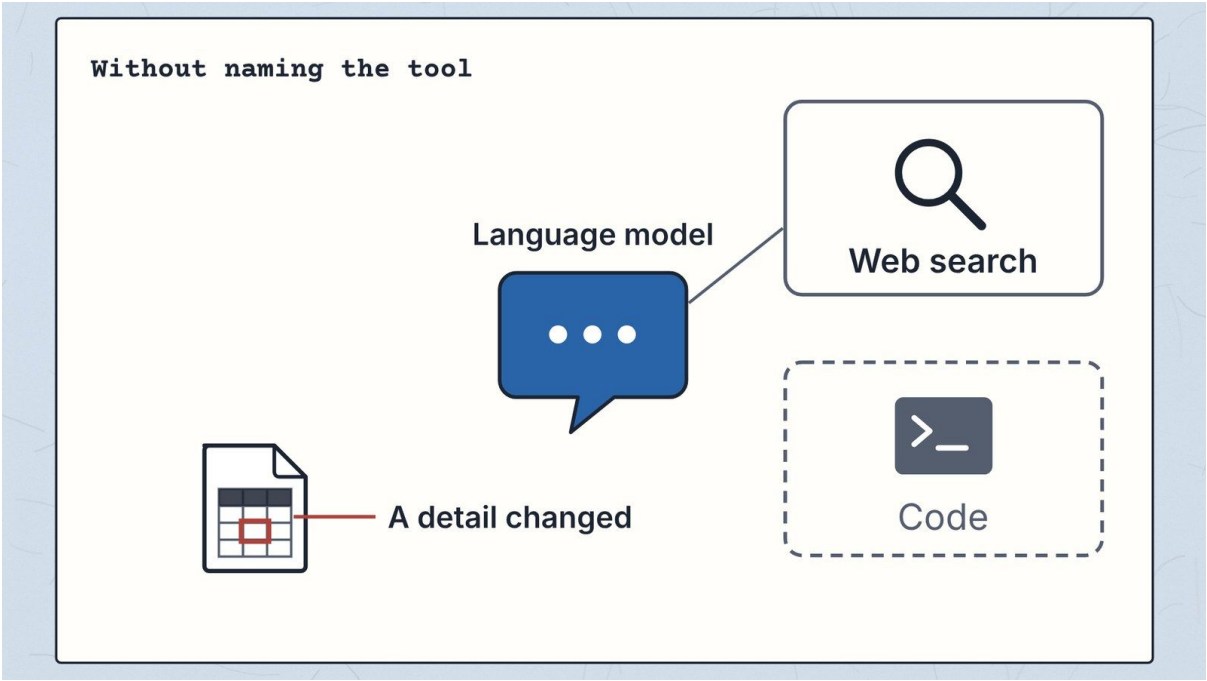
On screen

- Without naming the tool
- Language model
- A detail changed
- Web search
- Code

What you see

The question, the book and the calendar clear, and the Web search box returns to a solid outline. As the narration says “convert a file”, a small file appears on the left: a page with a grid of cells, like a spreadsheet. It moves into the chatbot, shrinking as it goes, and the label “Language model” appears above the chatbot.

As the narration says “rather than with code”, the Code box turns dashed and grey, and its line to the chatbot disappears. As it says “and make mistakes”, a copy of the file comes out of the chatbot and settles at the bottom left. As it says “change details”, one cell in the copy is outlined in red, with a short red line pointing to the label “A detail changed”. The file is an illustration, not a real example.



A detail changes when the file is converted without code.

5. Name the tool

0:29 to 0:39

Narration

So when you need something recent, exact or checkable, name the tool: web search for current information and code for calculations or converting files.

On screen

- Name the tool
- You choose
- Use web search
- Current information
- Use code
- Calculations, converting files

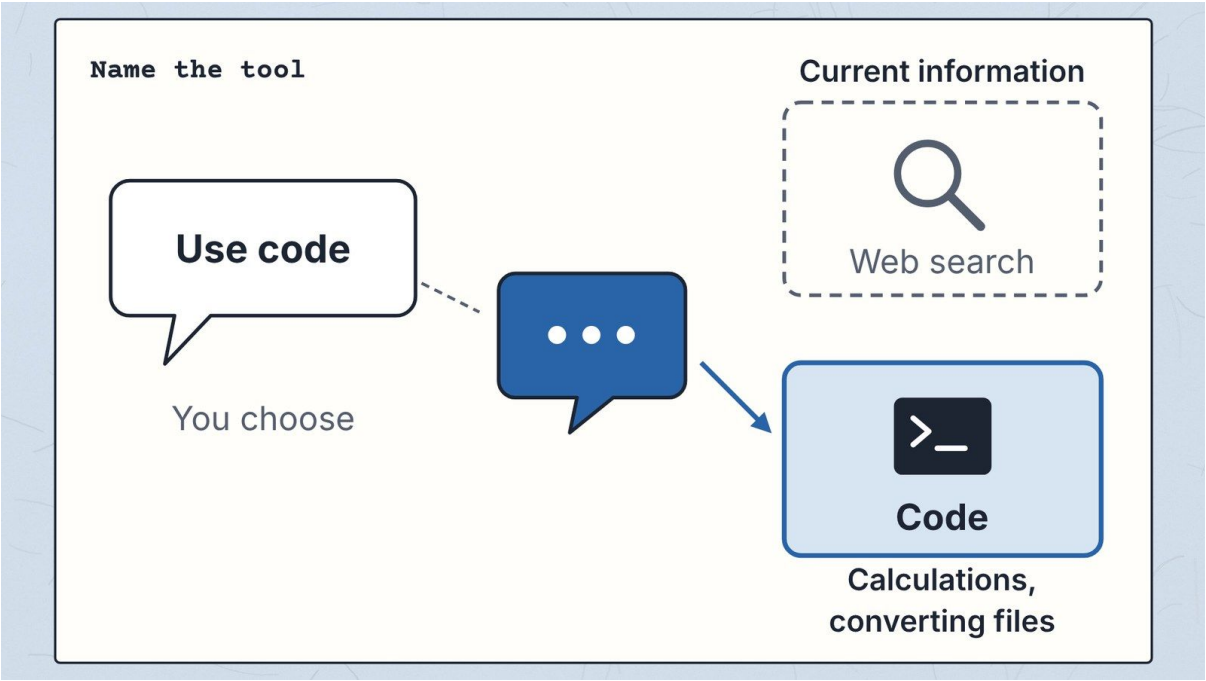
What you see

The label in the corner changes to “Name the tool”, and the panel returns to the card’s own layout. Your white speech bubble is on the left, labelled “You choose”, joined by a dashed line to the chatbot, and both tool boxes are dashed. While the narration says “recent, exact or checkable”, your bubble is empty, with a slowly blinking text cursor.

As the narration says “web search”, your bubble reads “Use web search”. A blue arrow runs from the chatbot to the Web search box, which turns pale blue with a blue outline, and the label “Current information” appears above it.

As the narration says “and code”, your bubble changes to “Use code”. The arrow moves to the Code box, which turns pale blue in the same way, and the Web search box turns dashed

again. The label “Calculations, converting files” appears below the Code box. The diagram now matches the one on the card, with the two labels added.



Naming the tool: use code.

6. Try this

0:39 to 1:02

Narration

Try this. Tell the chatbot which tools to use. For example: “Use web search to find the 2026 HEPI Student Generative AI Survey. Summarise what it says about how students use GenAI and link your sources.” Or: “Use code to merge these two CSV files together without changing any of the content.”

A two-second pause follows, at about 1:00, so there is time to read the second prompt on screen.

On screen

- Try this
- Use web search to find the 2026 HEPI Student Generative AI Survey, summarise what it says about how students use GenAI, and link your sources.
- Use code to merge these two .csv files together without changing any of the content.

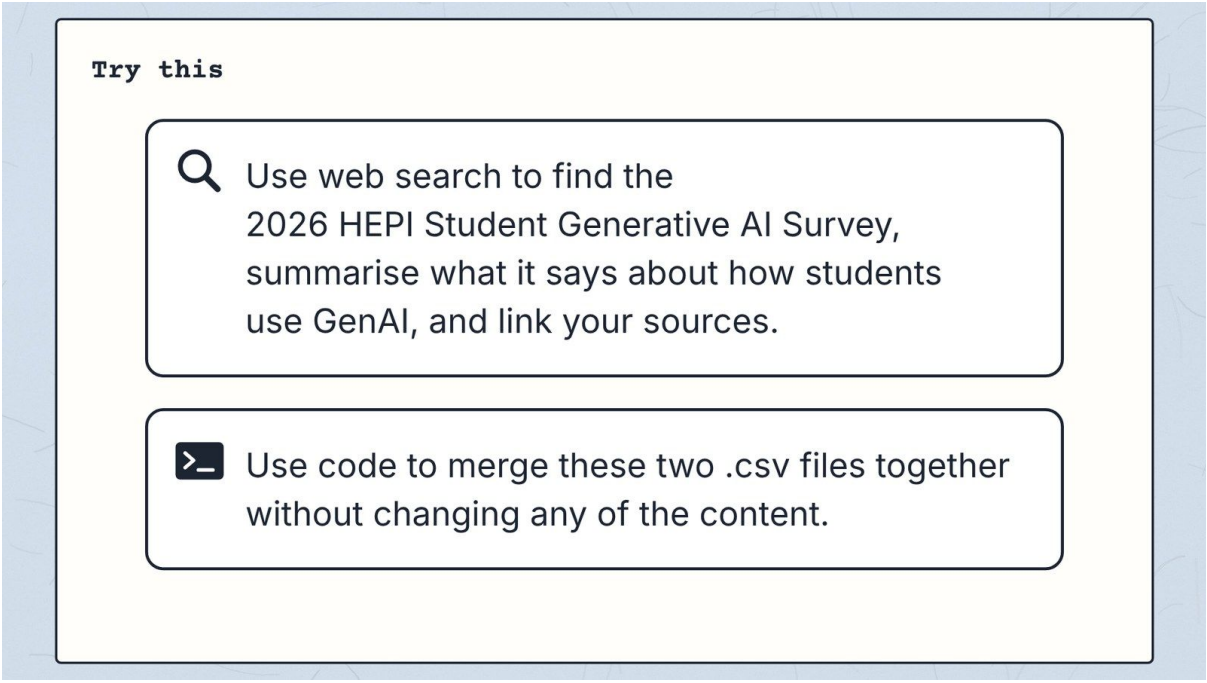
The prompts on screen use the wording from the written tip, which differs slightly from the narration.

What you see

The diagram clears, and the label in the corner changes to “Try this”. A white chat box appears, with a small magnifying glass at its top left and a slowly blinking text cursor. Just after the narration says “Survey”, the first half of the prompt appears, ending “Survey,”, and

the cursor moves to the next line. Just after “link your sources”, the rest of the prompt appears and the cursor stops.

As the narration says “Or”, a second chat box appears beneath the first, with a small terminal icon and a blinking cursor. Just after “any of the content”, the second prompt appears in full. Both prompts stay on screen through the pause.



The two example prompts.

7. Each time

1:02 to 1:15

Narration

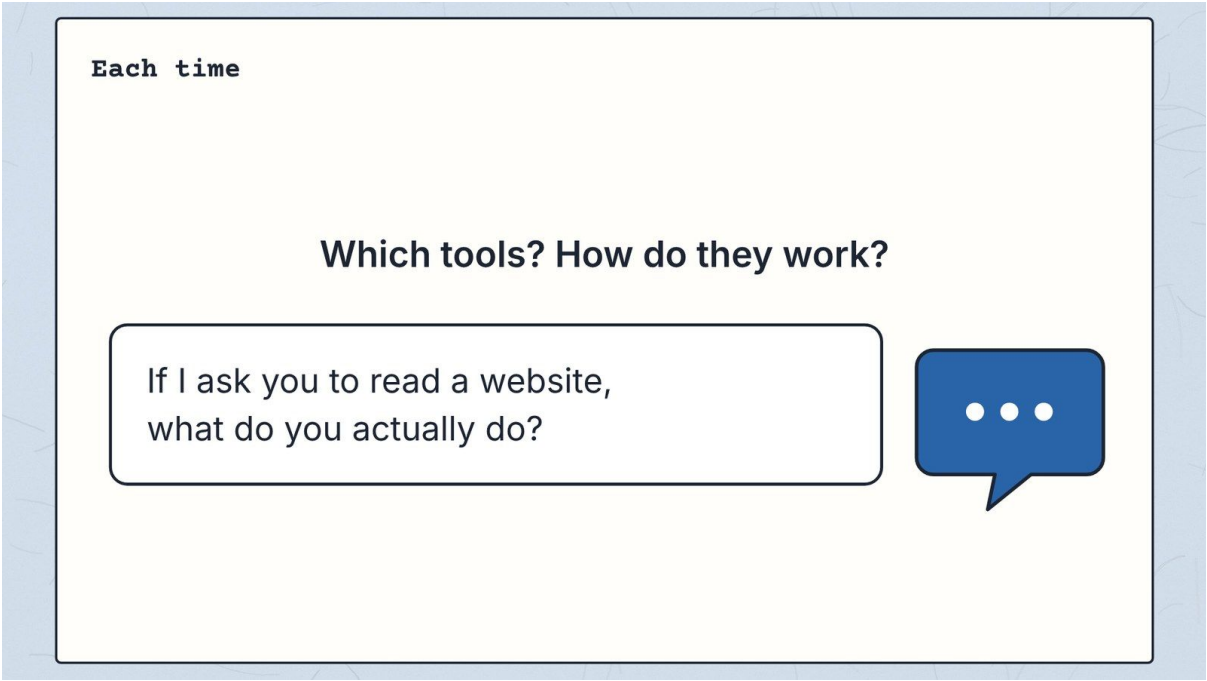
In the future, each time you use a chatbot, consider asking it what tools it used and how they work. For example: “If I ask you to read a website, what do you actually do?”

On screen

- Each time
- Which tools? How do they work?
- If I ask you to read a website, what do you actually do?

What you see

The chat boxes clear, and the label in the corner changes to “Each time”. As the narration says “what tools it used”, the words “Which tools? How do they work?” appear. As it says “For example”, a chat box appears beneath them with a blinking cursor, and the blue chatbot bubble appears beside it on the right, like a reply about to come. Just after “read a website”, the first half of the question appears. Just after “actually do?”, the rest appears and the cursor stops.



Asking the chatbot about its tools.

8. Back to the card

1:15 to 1:21

Narration

None.

What you see

The panel returns to the card's own layout, with the chatbot bubble moving back into place. The camera then zooms back out to the full card, framed exactly as at the start, and holds on it for about three seconds until the video ends.